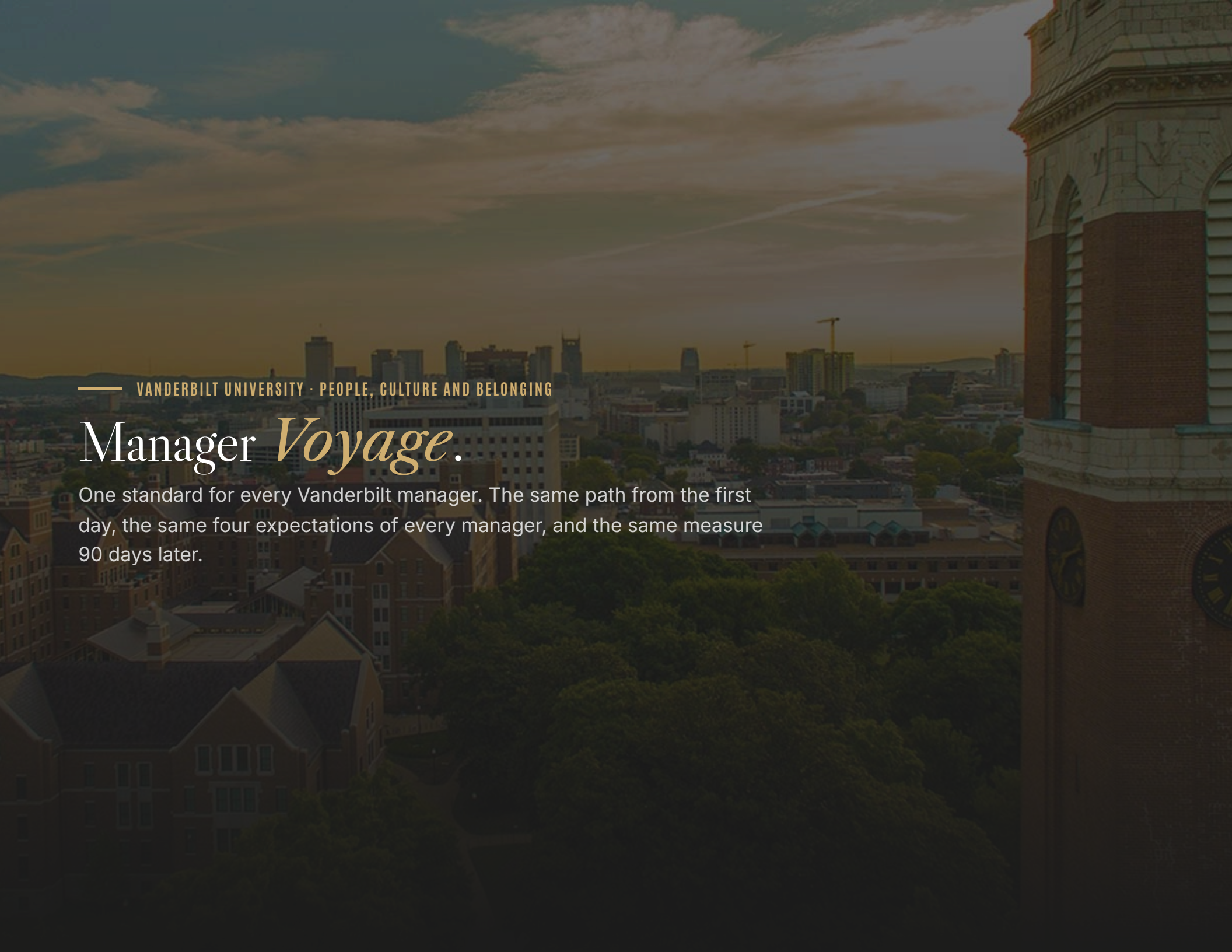


VANDERBILT UNIVERSITY · PEOPLE, CULTURE AND BELONGING

Manager *Voyage*.

One standard for every Vanderbilt manager. The same path from the first day, the same four expectations of every manager, and the same measure 90 days later.

The Vanderbilt Manager Standard: four *expectations*.

Four expectations of every manager, every week, the same in every business unit. Adapted from Gary Yukl's research on effective leadership behavior: his four categories, his fifteen behaviors, in Vanderbilt's words. The program teaches it, the assessment measures it, and the cohort practices it.

01

Get the work done through the team, not around it.

Yukl: task-oriented behavior. Plans it, says what good looks like, checks work before it is due, fixes the cause when something breaks twice. Measured by assessment statements 1 to 3.

02

Take care of the people on the team.

Yukl: relations-oriented behavior. Listens and helps, grows people, thanks them for specific work, hands over decisions and not just tasks. Statements 4 to 6.

03

Make the work better, not only keep it going.

Yukl: change-oriented behavior. Explains the why before a change lands, describes where the team is going, lets people try, looks back. Statements 7 and 8.

04

Connect the team to the rest of Vanderbilt.

Yukl: external behavior. Knows the people the team depends on, watches for what is coming, speaks up for the team with facts and options. Statements 9 and 10.

The standard, *continued*.

Fifteen behaviors inside the four expectations, Yukl's fifteen. Ten assessment statements, each one a behavior written as a weekly action, scored by expectation. One path from Day 1 to Day 60. Measured before the program and at 90 days.

WHERE THE STANDARD COMES FROM, AND HOW THE ASSESSMENT MEASURES IT

The standard is adapted from Gary Yukl's taxonomy of leadership behavior (*Academy of Management Perspectives*, 2012). The four expectations are his four categories, the fifteen behaviors are his fifteen, and each of the ten assessment statements is one behavior written as something a manager does in a normal week.

EXPECTATION	YUKL'S CATEGORY	THE FIFTEEN BEHAVIORS	ASSESSMENT STATEMENTS
01 Get the work done	Task-oriented	Planning, clarifying, monitoring, problem solving	1 Priorities, 2 Expectations, 3 Checking work
02 Take care of your people	Relations-oriented	Supporting, developing, recognizing, empowering	4 Supporting, 5 Recognizing, 6 Empowering
03 Make things better	Change-oriented	Advocating change, envisioning change, encouraging innovation, facilitating collective learning	7 Leading change, 8 Looking back
04 Connect your team	External	Networking, external monitoring, representing	9 Watching ahead, 10 Representing

The standard, *continued*.

WHERE THE STANDARD COMES FROM, AND HOW THE ASSESSMENT MEASURES IT

Five behaviors have no statement of their own (problem solving, developing, envisioning change, encouraging innovation, networking), so the ten statements sample the standard and the course teaches all fifteen. A self-reflection tool adapted for Vanderbilt, not a validated Yukl instrument, and not a performance evaluation.

02 PROGRAM OVERVIEW

What Manager Voyage *is*.

A manager's first 60 days shape how they will lead for years, and until now Vanderbilt had no common standard for that period. Manager Voyage provides one. Courses are assigned automatically in Oracle Learning from the HR record, and the dashboard shows each manager what to do now, what comes next, and who to call.

4,600+
Staff led by Vanderbilt managers

500+
Vanderbilt managers

39
Business units using the same standard

60
Days covered by the initial path

01 · REQUIRED

Compliance

DAYS 1 TO 60

The legal and policy courses a manager must complete, matched to the state where their team works.

02 · STRONGLY RECOMMENDED

Foundations

DAYS 1 TO 60 · COURSE BY DAY 7

What Vanderbilt expects of a manager: an assessment, a 35-minute course, and short modules in four tracks.

03 · OPTIONAL BUT RECOMMENDED

Four-week cohort

AFTER DAY 60 · QUARTERLY

Four weeks of guided practice with the manager's own team, for one hundred managers each quarter.

04 · ALWAYS AVAILABLE

Manager Portal

FROM DAY 1

Templates, policy links, and contacts in one place, available from the first day onward.

COMPONENT 01 · REQUIRED · DAYS 1 TO 60

Compliance *courses*.

The legal and policy courses every manager must complete. Oracle Learning assigns them on the manager's first day, based on the state where their team works. Supervisors complete both the all-staff version and the supervisor version.

Assigned in every location

Foundational Cybersecurity Training · HIPAA Privacy and Security · Addressing Harassment and Discrimination at Vanderbilt · Clery Act · Reasonable Accommodations in the Workplace (managers).

Assigned by state

Tennessee, New York, California, and Florida each add their own harassment-prevention and safety courses, with an all-staff version and a supervisor version.

ASSIGNMENT	Automatic in Oracle Learning when the HR record shows a management role. No enrollment step.
DEADLINES	Courses required by law are due within 30 days; policy courses within 60. My voyage shows the dates and flags anything at risk.
RENEWAL	Most courses renew every year, some every two years where the state allows. Oracle Learning holds the official record.

Component 01 · Compliance, *continued*.

EVERY COURSE, BY LOCATION

Every location

- Foundational Cybersecurity Training 30 MIN
- VU HIPAA Privacy and Security Training 60 MIN · LEGAL
- Addressing Harassment and Discrimination at Vanderbilt 35 MIN · LEGAL
- Clery Act 20 MIN · LEGAL
- Guidelines for Reasonable Accommodations in the Workplace 45 MIN · MANAGERS

Tennessee

- Eliminating Discrimination and Harassment in the Workplace 45 MIN
- Harassment Prevention: Manager Essentials 45 MIN · MANAGERS

New York

- Harassment Prevention for Employees, New York City and State 45 MIN · LEGAL
- Harassment Prevention for Supervisors 60 MIN · LEGAL
- New York Retail Worker Safety Act, staff and supervisors 30 MIN · RETAIL ONLY

California

- Sexual Harassment Prevention, employees (SB 1343) 60 MIN · LEGAL
- Sexual Harassment Prevention, supervisors 120 MIN · LEGAL
- Workplace Violence Prevention, employees and supervisors (SB 553) 30 TO 45 MIN · LEGAL

Florida

- Human Trafficking Awareness, lodging staff and supervisors 30 MIN · LEGAL
- Harassment Prevention, employees and supervisors 45 MIN

Delivered through OpenSesame inside Oracle Learning. Each course ends with a knowledge check.

COMPONENT 02 · STRONGLY RECOMMENDED · DAYS 1 TO 60

Manager *Foundations*.

What Vanderbilt expects of a manager, in three parts completed in order. Also assigned to every current manager.

01

The assessment

BEFORE THE COURSE · AGAIN AT 90 DAYS

Ten statements about what a manager actually does, each one a behavior from the Vanderbilt Manager Standard, rated never to always and scored by expectation. Results on screen and by email. The same ten again three months after the program.

02

The Foundation course

35 MINUTES · COMPLETE BY DAY 7

You Are a Manager Now: six topics, each with one activity. Live conversations with a team member who answers back, scored on what the manager says. Narrated and captioned.

03

The micro modules

DAYS 1 TO 60 · ORACLE LEARNING

Short modules, one common task each, in four tracks. Systems and Vanderbilt & Nashville by Day 30; People and Processes by Day 60.

Completing everything by Day 60 is recorded against the job profile and triggers the cohort invitation.

Component 02 · Manager Foundations, *continued*.

THE SIX TOPICS AND THE FOUR TRACKS

The Foundation course, six topics

- **What a manager is.** The one change, three things that are new, who helps you.
- **Five ideas.** Priorities, clear expectations, psychological safety, purpose, the people work. A live conversation for each.
- **Your first year.** What Vanderbilt asks for and when, and a three-tap week the manager adds to their calendar.
- **The Vanderbilt Manager Standard.** The four expectations, Yukl's category for each, the fifteen behaviors on flip cards, a story per expectation, and the map from expectation to assessment statement, then four live conversations.
- **Your assessment.** The result by expectation, which statements sit under each, and the first move.
- **Next steps.** One action this week, a note to their manager, course complete.

The micro modules, four tracks

- **Systems, by Day 30.** UKG for managers; Oracle time off; Oracle HCM team view and approvals; Oracle Recruiting and Onboarding; expense and procurement approvals.
- **Vanderbilt & Nashville, by Day 30.** The mission and vision; areas of focus; our campuses; Nashville; how we work together.
- **People, by Day 60.** Employee Relations grounding; EOA reporting duty; FMLA; reasonable accommodations; performance concerns simulator; onboarding a new hire.
- **Processes, by Day 60.** Performance Management Foundations; giving feedback; compensation and merit basics; flexible work; offboarding and transitions.

COMPONENT 03 · OPTIONAL BUT RECOMMENDED · QUARTERLY

The four-week *cohort*.

Where skill development happens. One hundred managers a quarter practice the skills from Foundations with their own teams, in the same weekly rhythm. Open to any manager who has completed compliance and Foundations; Oracle sends the invitation at Day 60.

BY MONDAY · 45 TO 60 MIN

Core module

A LinkedIn Learning course in Oracle Learning sets the topic and the vocabulary. Prework for the week it serves.

TUESDAY OR WEDNESDAY · 45 MIN, LIVE

Learning Lab

A facilitated small-group peer lab in SparkWise, working a live case from someone's real team.

THURSDAY · 15 MIN

Scenario Studio

The week's conversation, rehearsed in Yoodli with an AI counterpart grounded in Vanderbilt policy.

FRIDAY · 30 MIN VIRTUAL, 60 IN WEEKS 1 AND 4

Manager Voyage discussion

FLH-facilitated. What happened when you tried it, what your Playbook says now, what you commit to next week.

The Manager Playbook is the through-line: one section drafted each week and due by Sunday, then the whole thing presented at the capstone. About 90 minutes of prework, then two and a half to three hours a week, and about five hours in week 4.

LOGISTICS AND WHAT EVERY PARTICIPANT PRODUCES

Logistics

- **Kickoff.** One hour, hybrid, on the Monday of week 1. Location confirmed each quarter.
- **Capstone.** Two hours, hybrid, in week 4. Managers present to peers and their business unit leader.
- **Discussions.** Fridays, virtual, facilitated by the Futures Learning Hub.
- **Seats.** One hundred a quarter. Units outside the central budget are billed per seat.

Deliverables

- **Manager Playbook.** The written personal operating system: philosophy, 1:1 framework, delegation and growth plan, performance practice.
- **Integrated Management Model.** A one-page model of how the four weeks connect. Synthesis, not attendance.
- **Team Development Plan.** A 90-day plan for the actual team: names, goals, growth moves. Challenged by peers in week 4, presented at the capstone.

COMPONENT 03 · WEEK BY WEEK

Prework, then one topic a *week*.

PREWORK

Arrive from the same place

New Manager Foundations in Oracle Learning, the first sentence of your Philosophy, and the pulse survey. About 90 minutes.

WEEK 1

What it means to manage

The why before the how. By Friday you can say, in one sentence, what your team can expect from you.

WEEK 2

Goals, 1:1s, and difficult conversations

Daily operating discipline. A 1:1 cadence on the calendar, three goals per person, one hard conversation held.

WEEK 3

Coaching and mentoring

From directing to developing. One real decision handed over, one coaching conversation that was mostly questions.

WEEK 4

Performance and developing talent

Closing the loop. The finished Playbook, the Integrated Management Model, and a 90-day Team Development Plan at the capstone.

The cohort · Week by week, *continued*.

EACH WEEK IN DETAIL

Week 1 · What it means to manage

LIVE	Kickoff, one hour, hybrid. Management identity in one story from a Vanderbilt manager a year in, cohort norms, the Playbook introduced.
LAB	Psychological safety: make the truth cheap to tell. A team member brought bad news late; name the one reaction on your own team you would change.
DISCUSSION	60 minutes. Read your Philosophy sentence; a peer says what your team would notice by Friday if it were true.
PLAYBOOK	Section 1: Manager Philosophy. Three things your team can expect from you, what you say when bad news lands, your 90-day intent.

Week 2 · Goals, 1:1s, difficult conversations

CORE	How to Manage Difficult Conversations, LinkedIn Learning.
LAB	Bring one real conversation you have been putting off. Peers frame it in three lines: what you noticed, what you expect, what you need by when.
STUDIO	The 1:1 that turns into a difficult conversation. Dev has missed two deadlines and opens as if nothing is wrong.
PLAYBOOK	Section 2: 1:1 framework and conversation plan, three goals per person for the quarter.

Week 3 · Coaching and mentoring

CORE	Coaching Skills for Leaders and Managers, LinkedIn Learning.
LAB	Delegation lab and coach-or-correct lab: what you will hand off this month, to whom, with what boundary; then a real performance pattern.
STUDIO	A coaching conversation with Priya using GROW, then a handoff with one boundary and a check-in date.
PLAYBOOK	Section 3: Delegation and growth plan. For each person: where they want to be, one stretch assignment, their rung on the delegation ladder.

Week 4 · Performance and developing talent

CORE	Performance Management Foundations for Managers, Vanderbilt, in Oracle Learning.
LAB	Team development accountability lab. Present your draft 90-day plan to four peers in five minutes; they challenge one goal, one growth move, and one date.
STUDIO	Two performance conversations: Marcus, who expects a promotion you cannot give this cycle, and a redirect.
LIVE	Capstone, two hours, hybrid. Present the Integrated Management Model and the Team Development Plan. Deliverables recorded in Oracle Learning.

COMPONENT 04 · ALWAYS AVAILABLE

The Manager *Portal*.

One website with every template, framework, policy link, and contact from the course and the cohort. Open from a manager's first day, never taken away, kept current by People, Culture and Belonging.

TEMPLATES	The 1:1 agenda, the three-line conversation frame, the delegation ladder, the Playbook, the Team Development Plan.
POLICY	Leave, flexible work, accommodations, performance, every route in one place with the office it goes to.
BEYOND	Vetted outside resources, each naming its source: podcasts, videos, guides.

WHO TO CALL

Same-day routes and everyday *help*.

YOUR HCM	Positions and hiring, payroll and timecards, assignments, the first step of leave, costing, records. The first call when unsure, the same day.
ENGAGEMENT CONSULTANT	The bigger people questions: a pattern, a hard conversation to plan, a team dynamic.
LEAVE OFFICE	Health and family time off, including FMLA, and injuries at work. The same day, and never ask for a diagnosis.
EOA	Discrimination, harassment, sexual misconduct, retaliation. Report the same day. You do not investigate.

HOW IT WAS BUILT, AND HOW IMPACT IS MEASURED

A pilot, an expert group, and a *measure*.

THE EXPERT GROUP

Seven divisions

Subject-matter experts defined the routing rules, the who-to-call directory, and what a manager must be able to do by Day 30 and Day 60.

THE PILOT · MARCH 26, 2026

Fifteen managers, eight units

They completed the full program. Their feedback shaped the current design.

NOW LIVE

Automatic assignment

Compliance and Foundations assigned from the HR record. The Manager Portal open to every manager.

NOVEMBER 1, 2026

Wide launch

Open to all managers across the university, with the first full cohort of one hundred.

REACH	The share of managers enrolled, recorded in Oracle Learning. Target: 80 percent of M1 to M5 managers.
CHANGE	The ten-statement assessment before the program and again 90 days after, scored by the four expectations of the Vanderbilt Manager Standard. Target: each manager improving in at least three of the four.
LATER	An optional six-month pulse, and in a later phase, direct reports answering the same statements about their manager.

How it was built · How impact is measured, *continued*.

THE OUTCOMES WE EXPECT, AND HOW WE WILL SEE THEM

Engaged

- Managers who understand the role, take ownership of it, and stay at Vanderbilt.
- **How we will see it:** enrollment and Day 60 completion in Oracle Learning against the 80 percent target; cohort seats filled each quarter.

Supporting

- Teams with clear expectations, timely feedback, and the confidence to raise concerns.
- **How we will see it:** assessment gains in getting the work done and taking care of people.

Championing

- Managers who can explain Vanderbilt's purpose in their own words and connect the team's work to it.
- **How we will see it:** assessment gains in making things better and connecting the team; completion of the Vanderbilt & Nashville track.

The standard and the assessment are adapted from Yukl's taxonomy of leadership behavior (2012): the four expectations are his four categories and the ten statements are ten of his fifteen behaviors. An adaptation for Vanderbilt, not a validated instrument, and not a performance evaluation.

MANAGER DEVELOPMENT JAM SESSION · WHAT WE HEARD

You stated. We *listened*.

Before Manager Voyage was designed, managers and leaders from across Vanderbilt came together in a Manager Development Jam Session and told us what the program had to do. Five themes came out of that room. Each one shaped a specific part of the program.

YOU STATED	WE LISTENED
Make it practical. *"Give managers simple tools for 1:1s, people decisions, difficult situations, and the everyday work of managing."*	Every activity in the Foundation course is a conversation a manager will actually have, and the course ends with a three-tap week the manager adds to their calendar: 1:1s, the team meeting, the monthly and quarterly work, and what to do as needed. The Manager Portal holds the 1:1 agenda, the three-line conversation frame, the delegation ladder, and every policy route with the office it goes to, from Day 1 onward.
YOU STATED	WE LISTENED
Learn across Vanderbilt. *"Use cross-functional cohorts to build relationships, empathy, and a better understanding of how the university works."*	The four-week cohort seats one hundred managers a quarter from across the 39 business units, in small Learning Labs that work a live case from someone else's team, with a hybrid kickoff and capstone where managers present to peers from other units. The Vanderbilt & Nashville track covers the mission, the areas of focus, our campuses, and how we work together, and Who to call names the people a manager's team depends on.

You stated. We listened., *continued*.

YOU STATED	WE LISTENED
Learn by doing. *"Blend in-person experiences, real scenarios, SMEs, and practice in the flow of work."*	The course teaches through live conversations with a team member who answers back, scored on what the manager says. The cohort rehearses each week's conversation in a Scenario Studio grounded in Vanderbilt policy, then has it for real: one 1:1 cadence set, one hard conversation held, one decision handed over, with the manager's own team. Subject-matter experts from seven divisions wrote the routing rules and the Day 30 and Day 60 expectations, and fifteen managers from eight units tested the whole program first.
Build the talent bench. *"Help managers spot potential, create enrichment opportunities, enable lateral and diagonal mobility, and develop their successors."*	Growing people and handing over decisions, not just tasks, are written into the standard itself. Week 3 of the cohort is coaching and mentoring: for each person on the team, where they want to be, one stretch assignment, and their rung on the delegation ladder. The Team Development Plan sets 90-day growth moves by name, is challenged by peers in week 4, and is presented to the business unit leader at the capstone.
Reinforce how we lead. *"Build shared expectations around collaboration, accountability, sound people practices, and care for frontline staff."*	The Vanderbilt Manager Standard: four expectations of every manager, adapted from Yukl's research, the same in every business unit, taught in the course, measured by the ten-statement assessment before the program and again at 90 days, and practiced in the cohort. Compliance and the People track put sound people practice on every manager's path, and taking care of the people on the team is one of the four categories, not an elective.

You stated. We listened., *continued*.

THE COMMITMENTS WE MADE IN THE ROOM, AND WHERE THEY LED

Next steps named at the jam session

- Validate internal versus external hiring manager data.
- Invite DAR and Facilities as volunteer pilot partners.
- Present the manager development prototype to VBOM for feedback and further refinement.
- Schedule the next session to review and refine the prototype.

How the program keeps listening

- The pulse survey in cohort prework and the Friday discussions, where managers say what happened when they tried it.
- The ten-statement assessment before the program and at 90 days, which shows where the program is working and where it is not.
- Feedback from each cohort shapes the next quarter's design, the same way the pilot shaped this one.

From the jam session to launch

STEP 1

Jam session

Managers and leaders set the five themes and the next steps.

STEP 2

Expert group

Seven divisions defined the routing rules, Who to call, and the Day 30 and Day 60 expectations.

STEP 3 · MARCH 26, 2026

Pilot

Fifteen managers from eight units completed the full program. Their feedback shaped the current design.

STEP 4 · NOVEMBER 1, 2026

Wide launch

Open to all managers, with the first full cohort of one hundred.

WHERE TO START

Start with My *voyage*.

My voyage is the dashboard where a manager sees what to do now, what comes next, and who to call. The Foundation course and the Manager Portal are open to every manager today.

Manager Voyage · Futures Learning Hub · People, Culture and Belonging · Vanderbilt University